IS413 Advances in ICT: Course Outline (Sample)

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IS413 is assessed through six pieces of work worth 100%, with a 35% final exam; a pass needs 50% overall. This is a sample outline written to match the test file IS413_current_marksheet.csv for the USP At Risk Tracker. It is not an official USP course outline, and names, dates and policies should be replaced with the real ones before use.

Course details

Item	Detail
Course code	IS413
Course title	Advances in ICT
Programme	BCom (Information Systems) and related degrees
Level	400, final year
Semester	Semester 2, 2026
Campus and mode	Laucala, face to face, with recordings on Moodle
Credit	1 course (15 credit points)
Contact hours	2 lectures, 1 tutorial and 1 two hour lab each week
Prerequisites	IS222 and IS314, or equivalent
Course coordinator	To be confirmed
Consultation	Two hours each week, times posted on Moodle

Course description and learning outcomes

IS413 examines current and emerging information and communication technologies and how organisations in the Pacific adopt them. Topics include cloud platforms, data analytics, artificial intelligence, automation, cybersecurity and digital government, with attention to cost, connectivity and governance in small island states.

On completing the course, students will be able to:

1. Explain how emerging technologies such as cloud, AI and automation work and where they add value.
2. Evaluate an ICT proposal for cost, risk, security and fit with an organisation's needs.
3. Analyse data with current tools and present findings to decision makers.
4. Design a small solution using a cloud or low code platform in the lab.
5. Assess the ethical, legal and social effects of new technology in a Pacific setting.

Assessment

Coursework is worth 65% and the final exam 35%. The names, weights and marks below match the column headings in the marksheet, so the file uploads to the At Risk Tracker without changes.

Assessment	Type	Weight	Marked out of	Due	Outcomes
Quiz 1	Quiz	5%	20	Week 3	1
Assignment 1	Coursework	15%	40	Week 5	1, 2
Lab Test	Practical	10%	100	Week 6	3, 4
Mid Semester Test	Test	20%	50	Week 8	1, 2, 3
Assignment 2	Coursework	15%	40	Week 11	2, 4, 5
Final Exam	Exam	35%	100	Exam period	1 to 5
Total		**100%**			

In the marksheet, Quiz 1 to Assignment 2 are marked and the Final Exam column is blank, because it has not been sat yet. That is 65% of the course assessed.

Passing the course and grades

A student passes with a final mark of 50% or more, combining all six assessments by their weights. This outline sets no separate exam minimum, which keeps it consistent with how the tracker calculates a pass; add one here if the real course has it.

Grade	Final mark
A+	85% and above
A	78% to 84%
B+	71% to 77%
B	64% to 70%

Grade	Final mark
C+	57% to 63%
C	50% to 56%
D (fail)	Below 50%

Weekly schedule

The exam period follows week 14. Adjust the weeks to the real academic calendar, including the mid semester break.

Week	Topic	Assessment
1	Course overview; the ICT landscape in the Pacific	
2	Cloud computing: models, costs and connectivity	
3	Data management and data quality	Quiz 1 (5%)
4	Data analytics and visualisation	
5	Business intelligence and dashboards	Assignment 1 due (15%)
6	Lab skills review	Lab Test (10%)
7	Artificial intelligence and machine learning basics	
8	Revision	Mid Semester Test (20%)
9	Automation and low code platforms	
10	Cybersecurity and risk	
11	Digital government and e-services	Assignment 2 due (15%)
12	ICT project evaluation and governance	
13	Ethics, privacy and law	
14	Review and exam preparation	
Exam period		Final Exam (35%)

Submissions, missed work and support

Work not submitted by its due date, without an approved extension, is recorded as NS and counts as 0. Extensions and special consideration need an application with supporting evidence before, or as soon as possible after, the due date.

The course uses the At Risk Tracker to spot students who need help early. After each assessment is marked, results are uploaded and every student goes through two checks:

1. **Arithmetic.** From the weights above: whether a pass can still be reached, and the average needed on the remaining work.

2. **Random forest.** For students where a pass is still open: the chance of failing, based on how similar past students finished.

Students flagged as at risk or borderline are contacted by the course coordinator and may be referred to Student Learning Support. Being flagged is an invitation to talk, not a mark against the student. Student IDs are pseudonymised in the tracker and no names are stored.